Step 1: Establish the current behavior

Start with a concrete request whose behavior you understand. In this appendix, the request is:

```
{
  "principal": "User::\"kate\"",
  "action": "Action::\"view\"",
  "resource": "Document::\"q3-plan\""
}
```

Confirm that the request is currently permitted and ask the AI to explain why. The explanation should reference a specific policy and identify the relationship or condition that makes the request valid. This step ensures that any change is grounded in a correct understanding of the existing policy behavior.

Step 2: State the desired outcome precisely

Next, articulate the change in intent as clearly as possible. For example, the desired outcome here is not “change access to the document,” but “deny this specific request while leaving other customer access unchanged.”

Precision matters. Vague intent leads to overly broad policy changes and unintended side effects.

Step 3: Ask the AI to explore implementation options

With intent clearly stated, ask the AI how the desired outcome could be achieved. Encourage it to propose multiple approaches rather than a single solution.

At this stage, the AI may suggest introducing a new forbid policy, narrowing an existing permit policy, or refactoring logic using an unless clause. Treat these as alternative expressions of the same intent, not as recommendations.